# KEY RAMAYAN CIRCUIT SITES

## Distances, Access, and Highlights

### 1. Punaura Dham, Sitamarhi
- Distance from Patna: ~137 km by road (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 3.5–4.5 hours by road or train.
- Highlights: Believed to be Sita's birthplace; features Janaki Kund and shrines to Lord Ram, Sita, Lakshman, Urmila, Bharat, Mandavi, Hanuman, and Shiva.

### 2. Haleshwar Sthan, Sitamarhi
- Distance from Patna: ~140 km (3 km northwest of Sitamarhi) (approx.)
- How to Reach: Accessible via Sitamarhi by road or local transport.
- Highlights: Site of King Janaka's Haleshti Yajna; houses an ancient Shiva temple.

### 3. Panth Pakar, Sitamarhi
- Distance from Patna: ~145 km (8 km from Sitamarhi) (approx.)
- How to Reach: Reach Sitamarhi by road/train; local transport to Panth Pakar.
- Highlights: Believed to be Sita's first stop after marriage; features an ancient banyan tree.

### 4. Girijasthan Temple, Phulhar (Madhubani)
- Distance from Patna: ~195 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 5 hours by road; nearest railhead at Madhubani.
- Highlights: Site of Lord Ram and Sita's first meeting; home to the Girijasthan temple.

### 5. Ahilya Sthan, Darbhanga
- Distance from Patna: ~123 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 3 hours by road or train to Darbhanga; local transport to Ahilya Sthan.
- Highlights: Site where Lord Ram liberated Ahilya; features a temple commemorating the event.

### 6. Ram Rekha Ghat, Buxar
- Distance from Patna: ~124 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 2 hours by train or road.
- Highlights: Site where Lord Ram performed rituals after defeating Tadaka; features a revered Shivling.

### 7. Ahirauli, Buxar
- Distance from Patna: ~131 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 3 hours by road; local transport from Buxar.
- Highlights: Associated with the redemption of Ahilya; holds spiritual significance.

### 8. Giddheshwar, Jamui
- Distance from Patna: ~151 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 3.5 hours by road or train to Jamui; local transport to Giddheshwar.
- Highlights: Believed to be the site where Jatayu confronted Ravana; features the Giddheshwar Mahadev Temple.

### 9. Ramchaura, Vaishali
- Distance from Patna: ~35 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 1 hour by road.
- Highlights: Site where Lord Ram is believed to have bathed before proceeding to Janakpur; features a temple with Lord Ram's footprints.

### 10. Village of Tar, Bhojpur
- Distance from Patna: ~70 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 2 hours by road.
- Highlights: Believed to be the site where Lord Ram killed the demoness Tarka; features an ancient water tank.

### 11. Sita Kund, Gayaji
- Distance from Patna: ~100 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 2.5 hours by road or train to Gayaji; local transport to Sita Kund.
- Highlights: Site where Sita performed Pind Daan for King Dasharatha; features a sacred kund.

### 12. Sita Kund, Munger
- Distance from Patna: ~180 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 4.5 hours by road or train to Munger; local transport to Sita Kund.
- Highlights: Associated with Sita's Agni Pariksha; features a naturally hot spring.

### 13. Sita Thapa, Aurangabad
- Distance from Patna: ~140 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 3.5 hours by road..
- Highlights: Believed to be a resting place for Lord Ram, Sita, and Lakshman during their exile; features Sita's handprints.

### 14. Valmiki Nagar, West Champaran
- Distance from Patna: ~290 km (approx.)
- How to Reach: Approximately 7 hours by road or train to Narkatiaganj; local transport to Valmiki Nagar.
- Highlights: Site of Sage Valmiki's ashram; where Sita took refuge and gave birth to Lava and Kusha.



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